MERIDIAN FORGE / ANALYST DOCUMENT · WEEK 02

Business Case Recommendation

Analyst Recommendation on Suggested Evaluations and Approvals · Revision 7156

QA Control Review · A recommendation for the sponsor

1. Need, value and scope

Proposed project

I recommend that we evaluate the QA control review of the affected QA cell.

Business need

It is imperative that we establish the following: someone who owns command authorization, how retired tests are controlled, and how our current evidence will be preserved and used for the future.

Expected value and beneficiaries

QA and Engineering can benefit from a review by being able to trace tangible records.
Operations can benefit from a review by having the authority to submit a request for further work.

Included work

As written in W02-S03, the necessary work includes:
1) QA requesting multiple records such as one command-ownership record, one scheduling/retirement control inventory, and one evidence-preservation checklist.
2) a relevant custodian locating one of the mentioned records.
3) QA and Operations examining the origin and meaning of the record
4) Create a summary for operation to use in the future

Excluded work

This review does not request or authorize:
- A restart of the machine
- Software changes
- Altering original records
- Replacing the machine

2. Feasibility and limits

Technical feasibility

The current available tools and R-OEs (read-only exports) cannot support the review, and exports with the necessary tools to support the review have been requested and approval is pending.

Operational feasibility

While it is possible, and not yet confirmed, for the analysts, engineers, QA, and Operators to simultaneously complete this plan while performing their respective roles, it is potentially an unrealistic ask, and all of these departments have yet to confirm their availability for the plan.

Cost and resource feasibility

As stated by the estimate and success-measure sheet, the $2,820 base estimate is just that, an estimate; it assumes the total ideal pay of all staff members after 48 staff hours, neglecting to take into account purchasing equipment, overtime hours, or accesses and licensing. The same goes for the estimated monetary range of the plan, which could vary widely anywhere from $180 less than or $525 more than the supplied envelope.

Schedule feasibility

The eight-business-day plan depends heavily on factors that we have yet to investigate, such as the necessary equipment, licenses, and even overtime pay. While it may seem tempting to complete in just eight days, considering the ten day deadline, there is no guarantee that access or the required staff will be available in that time.

Known constraints

While there is no settled budget, a suggested monetary envelope of $3,000 is being used as a limit in this proposal. While maintaining regular duties, it is projected that the on-duty staff will fulfill the plan within eight days, with two business days to spare from the deadline. Hours and staffing have yet to be determined. As of now, access to necessary exports has been requested but not confirmed, which are vital to the plan and must be approved by the third day to avoid revising or deferring the work.

Risks and assumptions

Much could go wrong, such as the late delivery of vital exports, which would slow down the progression of the plan to a halt. The assumption that the exports will be delivered on day three, allowing the engineers to begin work on day four, must be checked by both QA and Engineering as the plan does not have the necessary tools otherwise to continue as it is, and must be either reworked or deferred.

3. Recommendation and next decision

Success measures and evidence

QA will produce results and values for the sponsor to regularly check deliveries and later values. With the current knowledge we have now, future savings are impossible to estimate, as four of the six requests for the baseline do not have confirmations about connections to other custodians and original sources.

Recommendation

proceed

Rationale and conditions

As stated in W02-S01, the expected value of proceeding with the QA Control Review will yield traceable records that QA and Engineering will be able to use to investigate further, and provide Operations with a reason to request more work. Additionally, the evidence that drove my final decision, was W02-S03, which projects that proceeding with the review will yield useful deliverables and proof that will immediately allow us to fill in gaps with something besides our guesswork. Proceeding with the plan, however, would be accepting the risk of staff availability, critical delays, and reassignments as detailed in W02-S04.

Next authorization or information step

QA and Engineering should obtain the command-authorization record to begin their work on examining its origins, such as the sender or sending device. Operations should document evidence to be preserved and identify gaps for a later report in order to make later decisions.

Source packet

W02-S01 · Request for a bounded review — Mara Ilyan · Production Operations Manager

W02-S02 · Evidence-retrieval workload — Nia Voss · Night QA Supervisor

W02-S03 · Proposed scope and current workflow — Mara Ilyan with Nia Voss · Review draft

W02-S04 · Capacity, access and operating limits — Elias Chen · Robotics Systems Engineer

W02-S05 · Estimate and success-measure sheet — Mara Ilyan · Planning estimate, not a quote

All case records and figures are fictional teaching data. This report does not authorize spending or operating equipment. The instructor evaluates the reasoning; completed fields are not a grade.